

# Ernest SONG ♦ Finance Domain Leader

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Accounting-focused Finance Domain Leader for General Accounting (GL, AP, AR) and financial-close leadership (interim / transformation mandates). Skilled at ERP implementation and ERP replacement (SAP S/4HANA, new-ERP platforms), delivering AS-IS to TO-BE process design, Business Blueprint sign-off, and cross-functional workshops across multi-entity, multi-country (BE, FR, NL) environments. A dependable interim leader who aligns finance sub-processes with business goals and delivers trustworthy Power BI / Cognos reporting.

## Education

### ESCP Business School

(#1 FT 2026)  
2010 – 2011 | Paris, FR  
Specialized Master's degree  
Auditing and Consulting

### Université Paris Nanterre

2005 – 2010 | Paris, FR  
Master's degree  
Management Science and Financial Control

## Competencies

### Accounting – Finance

- General Accounting (GL, AP, AR)
- Financial Close
- Consolidated GL Reporting

### ERP Implementation – Replacement

- ERP replacement (new-ERP platform readiness)
- SAP S/4HANA
- AS-IS → TO-BE process design
- Business Blueprint (BBP) sign-off

### Financial Reporting → BI

- MS Power BI
- Cognos
- Business Object

### RPA / Automation

- UiPath
- MS PowerAutomate
- PowerQuery ETL

### Workshops → Stakeholders

- Cross-functional workshops
- MS PowerPoint (workshop presentations)
- Change – communication
- User training

### Agile → Tools

- Jira
- Confluence
- MS Office (advanced Excel / Power Query)

## Languages

**Native:** French, Khmer, Teochew

**Proficient:** English

**Basics:** Dutch (A2), Spanish, Mandarin

## Interests

Sustainable development, Powerlifting, Mountain biking, Tennis

## Interpersonal

Fast-learner, Problem solver, Diplomacy, Driven, Autonomous, Teamplayer

## Professional Experience

### Engie SEM

January 2026 – Present | Brussels, BE

#### Strategic Business Analyst & Finance Automation Lead (Freelancer)

- Led month-end/year-end GL close for up to 6 BE/FR/NL entities (ERP replacing legacy AS/400), strengthening financial-close control across the multi-entity group.
- Drove AS-IS to TO-BE process design for finance sub-processes, coordinating cross-functional workshops and stakeholder sign-off.
- Automated the financial close with PowerQuery ETL, ingesting 1,500+ bookings per close with zero manual intervention.
- Trained end-users on Infor M3 and validated UAT for finance sub-processes before go-live, documenting steering-committee sign-off.

### Holcim

January 2024 – December 2025 | Nivelles, BE

#### Senior Operational Excellence & Data Lead (Freelancer)

- Managed the SAP HANA ERP data migration, restructuring data and preserving system integrity.
- Rolled out Qlik Sense finance reporting, building 8 executive dashboards that shortened reporting cycles by 50% and enabled faster, evidence-based managerial decisions.
- Built rebate models (matrix & automated SAP) aligned to commercial strategy, driving €150M annual rebate volume with 99.8% accuracy and resolving commercial disputes 30% faster.
- Guaranteed data reliability and partnered with auditors on rebate matters.

**Engie Tractebel***March 2023 – December 2023 | Brussels, BE***Cash Flow & Financial Modeling Specialist (Freelancer)**

- Designed cash-flow reporting and per-project financing-need assessment.
- Assessed local financing needs, performed countercredit analysis, and conducted impairment testing.
- Engineered finance data models from SAP HANA, delivering 8 Power BI executive dashboards that turned raw transactions into decision-ready insights for finance leadership.

**Shurgard***February 2022 – February 2023 | Brussels, BE***Investment & Corporate Development Analyst (Freelancer)**

- Analyzed and managed real estate projects, including construction, redevelopment, and acquisition of self-storage businesses.
- Maintained project dashboard and initiated corporate development projects to improve department policies and procedures.
- Designed the data model and visualization for the Investment department's Business Intelligence efforts.
- Collaborated in the development of a new pricing model using Artificial Intelligence.

**Magnetrap***November 2020 – January 2022 | Mons, BE***Head of Controlling**

- Implemented budgeting, forecasting, and financial-control (controlling) systems.
- Produced cash-flow projections, business plans, and long-term financial goals.
- Monitored company performance and drove corrective actions.
- Prepared operating results reports and maintained financial models for long-term use.

**Tobania***February 2020 – October 2020 | Brussels, BE***Director Business Process Automation**

- Led development and implementation of citizen developer business model using RPA and self-service BI, including pricing strategy and roadmap.
- Managed business development, including marketing strategy, pre-sales, and sales, and identified new business opportunities.
- Implemented process optimization, standardization, and harmonization to improve efficiency and profitability for customers.
- Provided regular, tailored reports to help customers monitor and control costs and make data-driven business decisions, and established change management structures and strategies to facilitate successful adoption of new processes and technologies.

**Soap collect***January 2019 – Present | Phnom Penh, KH***Founder**

- Established a non-profit organization focused on providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities.
- Formed partnerships with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning.

**Degroof Petercam***January 2018 – December 2018 | Brussels, BE***Performance Management Project Leader**

- Finance Transformation Operating Model (FTOM)
- Designed and implemented a client-centric performance management system.
- Optimized finance close process for improved governance, internal control, and data quality.
- Led projects related to regulatory reporting sourcing and followed BPM standards.
- Conducted gap analysis of business requirements and existing procedures to identify areas for improvement.

**Vinci Airports***February 2016 – December 2017 | Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT***Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling / Cursus Grand Talent**

- Value creation: valuation at 4 times of acquisition cost.
- Led deployment of airport operations at 50+ locations in various countries.
- Developed long-term financial business model including analysis of macroeconomic impact, capital expenditures, and concession valuation.
- Negotiated extension of concession contract with Portuguese authorities and implemented new financial business model to improve budgeting and forecasting processes.
- Managed accounting and financial reporting in accordance with BE-GAAP standards.

**Rexel***September 2014 – January 2016 | Paris, FR***Reporting Consolidation Manager**

- *Operated within automobile-parts distribution (€500M turnover, 12 entities / 3 countries), overseeing GL consolidated reporting and aligning AP/AR flows for strong financial-close control.*
- *Integrated SAP BPC and Cognos reporting, strengthening GL/AP consolidated reporting.*
- *Ran annual budgeting and monthly forecasting (actual vs. budget).*

**KPMG Audit***January 2011 – August 2014 | Paris, FR***Financial Auditor Supervisor**

- *Audited financial statements under multiple accounting standards (BE-GAAP, SOX), strengthening GL and financial-close controls.*
- *Audited financial modelling for long-term PPP contracts.*
- *Certified FP7 grant agreements; led audit teams and supervised auditors.*

**ICM - Brain & Spine Institute***November 2009 – August 2010 | Paris, FR***Deputy CFO Trainee**

- *Implemented the budget system and prepared business plans for the scientific teams.*
- *Established the internal control system for purchasing and donation processes and managed bank reconciliation.*
- *Prepared the institutional audit necessary for the certification by the "Comité de la Charte".*